

READING QUIZ 2 (20 MARKS)

Duration: 1 hour

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MATRIC NUMBER: A23CS0117

SECTION NUMBER: 23

Read the text and answer all questions that follow.

CULTURE SHOCK

- I Most of us are familiar with the term "culture shock". We may think of it as a temporary disorientation that comes from being exposed to a different language, different customs, food and so forth. What we do not often realize is that it is usually a rather profound reaction to fairly significant differences in the way people view, think and value the world. Tourists often experience culture shock at a superficial level. People who actually live in another culture can experience culture shock as an on-going reaction and adaptation to basic differences. Full-time foreign students or exchange students and expatriates living, studying or working in a different culture, often experience significant culture shock, sometimes on a continuous basis, throughout their stay abroad.
- II Most foreign students in year-long programs go through a fairly identifiable progression of adjustment to culture shock, although each student's experience is unique. While culture shock can be very uncomfortable, there is nothing wrong with it, or with the person experiencing it. It is also quite common for students to have a very positive and rewarding experience, despite having on-going adjustment problems with culture shock. Many would agree that the most rewarding exchanges come only when there is a pronounced experience of culture shock.
- III There are real physical and psychological impacts of arriving in a new culture. The victim of the culture shock will be afflicted by ailments without apparent origin, such as headaches, loss of appetite, fatigue and diarrhea. All his senses are on full alert with new sights, sounds, smells and tastes. His metabolism may take months to adapt to a new climate. Even while he is sleeping, the environment impacts on his senses, possibly influencing his dreams. His behavior towards other people will also change. He will feel impatient when other people do not speak his language and become angry when their systems of work are different, and seemingly wrong. Although the culture shock victim considers himself non-racist, he finds himself using generalizations about the locals; 'they' are rude and dirty, and 'they' do not like me.
- IV Regardless of the country one visits, things will never be done in the same manner as they are 'back home'. A person's personal identity is framed by the community he lives in. Part of the way he sees himself in relation to other people, is to belong to this or that group. One's personal identity becomes somewhat threatened when his familiar community is replaced by foreign landscapes, people and lifestyles. The given fact is all cultures are ethnocentric. They teach their members that their way is the right, natural and preferred way of doing things. When a person is exposed to another culture, with different values, behaviors and beliefs, there is a tendency to respond with defensiveness, labeling his own practices as right and the other culture as wrong, silly or even stupid.
- V Experiencing culture shock in university is common among new foreign students. Feelings of loneliness, anxiety, and fear of having to adapt to new culture and behavior may cause them to think twice about studying abroad. The thing to remember is that appropriate behavior can be learned

and the impact of culture shock can be lessened. Before leaving home, students are advised to familiarize themselves with the new culture they will soon be living in, such as by reading books, talking to people who have been there, and exploring relevant web sites. Finding out about the living conditions of local people, the political situation, the currency, climate and what the cuisine is like can help them tremendously in fighting the blues of being away.

- VI Cultural shock need not be unpleasant. It can also be one of those nice moments that occur unexpectedly to remind the newcomer that the new country is different to what they have gone through in their home country. Moving overseas presents many challenges that takes a person out of his comfort zone, extending him to achieve extraordinary things. In fact, one of the attractions of studying or working overseas is that one will be continually challenged by different encounters. It might be reassuring to know that once a person has passed the phases of culture shock, he will grow to be a more matured and open-minded.

1. Match each main idea below with its paragraph. Write the number of paragraphs on the line provided.

- (a) V : Early preparations lessen the severity of culture shock.
(b) I : Culture shock is the reaction to the uniqueness of a foreign culture.
(c) IV : The feelings of displacement contribute to culture shock.
(d) VI : The experiences of culture shock can be rewarding.
(e) III : It is normal for a newcomer to feel alienated in a different culture.
(f) II : The manifestations of culture shock vary among individuals.

(6 x 1m = 6 marks)

2. Find one word in the text which is a synonym to the following words. The number in parenthesis refers to the paragraph where the answer / word can be found.

- (a) adaptation (paragraph II) progression
(b) troubled, made miserable (paragraph III) afflicted
(c) affecting (paragraph III) influencing
(d) jeopardized (paragraph IV) threatened
(e) introduced (paragraph IV) exposed
(f) immensely (paragraph V) tremendously
(g) comforting (paragraph VI) unpleasant

(7 x 1m = 7 marks)

3. What do we normally overlook in culture shock?

We do not often realize is that it is usually a rather profound reaction to fairly significant differences in the way people view, think and value the world.

(1 mark)

4. In what way can culture shock be rewarding?

Culture shock can be rewarding by moving overseas presents many challenges that takes a person out of his comfort zone, extending him to achieve extraordinary things. It might be reassuring to know that once a person has passed the phases of culture shock, he will grow to be a more matured and open-minded.

(1 mark)

5. List **four** physical effects of culture shock.

(i) Headaches

(ii) Loss of appetite

(iii) Fatigue

(iv) Diarrhea

(1 mark)

6. How does ethnocentrism contribute to culture shock?

When a person is exposed to another culture, with different values, behaviors and beliefs, there is a tendency to respond with defensiveness, labeling his own practices as right and the other culture as wrong, silly or even stupid.

(1 mark)

7. List **two** ways to minimize culture shock.

(i) Familiarize ourselves with the new culture they will soon be living in, such as by reading books, talking to people who have been there, and exploring relevant web sites

(ii) Finding out about the living conditions of local people, the political situation, the currency, climate and what the cuisine is like.

(2 x 1m = 2 marks)

END OF QUESTION PAPER